

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Microsoft Security Consultant | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender XDR | Entra ID | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on expertise designing, deploying and optimising Microsoft security platforms across large enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel - including data source onboarding, KQL-based detection engineering, automation development and platform optimisation - alongside Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud, and Microsoft Entra ID. I have led enterprise-scale security platform deployments affecting over 8,000 users, built automation workflows to streamline detection and response, and consistently translated complex security requirements into effective, practical platform configurations. I am experienced engaging with technical infrastructure teams and non-technical senior stakeholders, making me well positioned to deliver high-impact client-facing Microsoft security solutions and contribute to practice development within a specialist consultancy.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Sentinel:** Platform design, data source onboarding, KQL detection engineering, analytics rules, workbooks, automation playbooks (Logic Apps/SOAR), alert triage
- **Microsoft Defender XDR:** Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 (M365) Defender - deployment, tuning, incident investigation
- **Microsoft Entra ID:** Identity architecture, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Microsoft Azure:** Azure security posture, Defender for Cloud, cloud workload protection, Azure Active Directory (AD)
- **Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR):** Playbook development, workflow automation, Logic Apps integration, PowerShell scripting
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content, proactive threat hunting, behavioural analytics, anomaly detection
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, end-to-end lifecycle management, root cause analysis, post-incident reporting
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus
- **CrowdStrike Falcon:** NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover - enterprise deployment and management
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Lead the design, deployment and ongoing optimisation of Microsoft Sentinel as the organisation's primary Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, including enterprise-wide log source onboarding, data connector configuration and KQL-based detection engineering
- Design and implement automation playbooks and SOAR workflows to streamline alert triage, incident response and routine security operations, materially reducing manual analyst effort
- Architect and manage Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO configurations across the enterprise estate, defining the organisation's identity security posture
- Operate and tune the Microsoft Defender XDR suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) at enterprise scale, responding to incidents and continuously improving detection coverage

- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and EDR platform, developing detections aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and leading threat hunting activities across endpoint and cloud telemetry
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS, working with infrastructure teams to drive risk-prioritised remediation cycles
- Conduct incident response engagements following NIST 800-61 procedures, communicating findings and recommendations clearly to both technical and non-technical stakeholders
- Produce technical documentation, security architecture guidance and executive reporting on platform health, detection coverage and security posture
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM controls, maintaining privileged account governance and endpoint security standards

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) and M365 Defender across 8,000 users, encompassing solution architecture, phased rollout and post-deployment tuning
- Onboarded multiple log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, developed KQL analytics rules and built monitoring workbooks that provided the security team with end-to-end visibility across identity, endpoint and cloud environments
- Designed and implemented Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies and MFA/SSO architecture, eliminating legacy authentication and securing all user identities
- Performed proactive threat hunting using Microsoft Sentinel KQL, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Splunk SPL, identifying threats ahead of automated alerting and producing detailed investigation reports
- Conducted structured vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus and advised infrastructure teams on remediation approaches, explaining risk in terms relevant to business and technical audiences
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation and ISO 27001 programme, developing security policies and technical evidence packs for external assessment
- Built PowerShell automation scripts to reduce repetitive security operations tasks and improve consistency of security control application across the estate

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Supported cloud security and infrastructure security operations across HICX's Software as a Service (SaaS) and Financial Technology (FinTech) platform, including Azure environment security hardening
- Administered identity and access management, MFA and SSO controls, and contributed to security quality assurance and infrastructure documentation
- Performed vulnerability assessments, security patching and monitored security event logs, escalating findings and supporting remediation activities

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and delivered the end-to-end Microsoft Sentinel deployment at UAL, onboarding enterprise-wide log sources, building a comprehensive KQL detection library aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, and integrating automated response workflows that reduced mean time to respond across all alert tiers
- Led the Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) platform rollout across 8,000 users, delivering full endpoint and identity security coverage from architecture design through go-live and subsequent optimisation
- Architected and deployed Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA for the entire user population, eliminating legacy authentication channels and implementing a robust, policy-driven identity security posture
- Built SOAR automation playbooks using PowerShell and Logic Apps-style workflows to orchestrate alert triage and common incident response actions, reducing analyst toil on high-frequency event patterns
- Delivered comprehensive vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck, achieving sustained reductions in critical and high-severity risk exposure across the estate

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)